

with one another that most of them have emigrated. Those emigrants have had success, and often a great deal of success, in the United States, France, Brazil, China, and many other countries. But in Galicia, where they have to deal with one another, Gallegos can't agree. Their tiny corner of Spain remains the poorest, most backward part of the country.

Vicki and I started and ended our three-month visit in Madrid, Spain's capital and, since the demise of Barcelona, the cultural, artistic, and business center of the country. Placido Domingo, the Spanish opera star, sings in the local opera house. But music in Madrid includes everything from *zarsuela*, a sort of light opera, to some of the finest jazz in Europe.

Spain was ruled by Moslem invaders for several hundred years, and the best place to see their influence is in the south. The mosque in Cordoba, the Alhambra in Grenada, and the cathedral in Seville takes you back a thousand years. Narrow footpaths, buildings with painted doors, and hidden patios add an air of mystery to your journey back in time.

Spain made great strides after kicking out the Moslems. At times, though, one gets the feeling that not all Spaniards have made it to the twentieth century. In 1985, for example, I saw a newspaper article entitled "Deodorants Can Eliminate Ugly Odors." The article featured an interview with a prominent "deodorantologist." (I'm translating here, but you get the point.) The deodorantologist affirmed that, although sweating is normal, one *doesn't* have to stink. I saw another article entitled "Vasectomy Is *Not* Synonymous with Castration."

Wide, sandy beaches line much of Spain's southern and eastern coasts. The beaches attract hordes of retired Europeans and a handful of retired Americans into prefab towns. Some retirees build grand villas for a fraction of what they would cost in Florida or the south of France. But the Mediterranean water in that part of Spain is filthy, and the weather and water are cool most of the year. Remember that Madrid is as far north as New York City. If you want warm days and